

G-CAF

GovDigital Composable Architecture Framework

Volume 17

Quick References & Operational Aids

v2.0

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Chapter 1

Quick Reference Card

Key Concepts

Concept	Definition	Example
PBC	Packaged Business Capability — unit of governance	Enterprise Management PBC
Tier	Vertical stack level (Experience, Capability, Platform)	Capability Tier
Frame	Horizontal cross-cutting concern	Governance Frame, Operations Frame
Contract	Standard interface agreement with versioned requirements	Security Contract v2.1
Gateway	Lifecycle checkpoint (Go/Kill/Hold/Recycle)	Design Gateway

5 Standard Contracts

Contract	Purpose	Key Contents
Security	Security baseline for all PBCs	AuthN, AuthZ, Encryption, Threat modeling
Data	Data governance requirements	Quality, Lineage, Privacy, Ownership
Integration	API/Event standards	Versioning, Schema evolution, SLAs
NFR	Non-functional requirements	Performance, Availability, Scalability
Operations	Operational standards	Monitoring, Support, BCM, Secrets

4 Gateways: Initiation (is this PBC needed?) → Design (is the architecture sound?) → Go-Live (is it production-ready?) → Retirement (can it be safely decommissioned?)

Chapter 2

G-CAF Lite: The Essential Guide

The 20-page distillation of 589 files into what you need to know.

Core Value Proposition

Metric	Target
Service Delivery	50–70% faster through reusable PBCs
Cost Reduction	30–50% via shared capabilities
Governance	100% through centralized oversight
Enterprise Visibility	Complete across all digital services
Change Impact	Bounded through versioned contracts

G-CAF Lite Sections

Section	Content
1. What is G-CAF?	Problem/solution, core value, central PBC concept
2. Architecture: 3T+2E	Experience, Capability, Platform Tiers + Governance, Operations Frames
3. PBC Basics	6 types, 5 classifications, lifecycle states
4. Gateway Process	4 gateways with decision criteria and outcomes
5. Quick Start by Role	Entity CIO, Architect, Developer, PMO, Procurement, Vendor
6. Key Principles	Top 10 principles every practitioner should know
7. Anti-Patterns	Most common mistakes and how to avoid them
8. Where to Go Next	Volume guide to the full 589-file framework

Chapter 3

Executive Briefing

The v1.x to v2.0 Change

Aspect	Before (v1.x)	After (v2.0)
Architecture Model	9 numbered layers	3 Tiers + 2 Frames
Communication	"Which layer is DPI? 6 or 7?"	"DPI is in the Platform Tier"
Industry Alignment	Custom model	Matches Gartner composable platform
PBC Types	5 types	6 types (Agent PBC added)
Principles	10 core principles	17 principles (+ Operational Excellence)
Functionality	Complete	Same — no capabilities removed

Key message: No functionality was removed. All capabilities from v1.x are preserved and better organized.

Chapter 4

Performance Metrics

Category	Key Metrics	Targets
PBC Catalog Health	Total Active PBCs, Reuse Rate, Duplicate Avoidance	Growing, >50%, 100%
Gateway Performance	Initiation/Design/Go-Live cycle time, Pass rate, Resubmission	<5d, >100%, <10d, >80%, <20%
Interface Stability	Breaking changes, Deprecation compliance, Schema compliance	Near zero, 100%, >95%
Technical Debt	Debt score distribution, Remediation rate, Legacy PBC Criticality	<20% Critical/High, >80%, Decreasing
Standard Contracts	PBCs per version, Migration compliance, Sunset adherence	100% current, 100%, On schedule
Composed Experiences	Experiences registered, PBCs per experience	Growing, 3–8 avg
DDA Performance	SLA adherence, Review cycle time, ARB escalation	95%, Within SLA, <10%

Chapter 5

Implementation Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Key Activities	Success Criteria
Phase 0: Foundation	Months 0–3	Establish PBC Catalog, operationalize DDA, Catalog operational, CIS, A classifying by 200 declassified	
Phase 1: Priority PBCs	Months 3–6	Initiation Gateway for 10+ PBCs, Critical PBC development, strengthen initiation contracts for existing systems	
Phase 2: Development	Months 6–18	Design Gateways, vendor PBC procurement, Design approval, Bt, live, Data evolution started, Data F	
Phase 3: Go-Live	Months 18–30	Go-Live Gateways, PBC activation, full Catalog, PBC interface, Catalog populated, Compliance	
Phase 4: Continuous	Months 30+	PBC lifecycle, evolution, retirement, contract management, Migration, System, Self-sustaining governance	

Chapter 6

Companion Documents Registry

Status	Count
Released	20 companion documents
Planned	17 companion documents (stubs)
Total	37 companion documents

Document Hierarchy

Category	Key Documents
Governance Companions	PBC Catalog Guide, PBC Gateway Handbook, PBC Documentation Template (8 sections), Operational Mo
Classification Companions	PBC Classification Guide
Standard Contract Companions	Security Architecture Contract, Data Architecture Contract, Integration Patterns, NFR Standards, Technolog
Agent Companions	Agent Governance Contract (Master + 8 sub-contracts)
Reference Companions	Architecture Patterns Guide, Strategy Support Document

Chapter 7

Folder Selection Matrix

20 folder blocks that can be composed based on purpose. Key navigation aid for the 589-file vault.

By Change Driver

Change Driver	Code	Required Folders
Architecture	CD-ARC	framework/principles/, framework/tiers/, theories/
Integration	CD-INT	framework/tiers/platform-tier/, contracts/integration, catalogs/G-CAF-045
Security	CD-SEC	framework/principles/security-*, contracts/security, support/security-policy-*
Governance	CD-GOV	framework/governance/, gateways/, business-drivers/precedence/
Agent/AI	CD-AGT	extensions/agent-extension/, examples/agent-scenarios/
Data	CD-DAT	contracts/data-contract, catalogs/G-CAF-044, support/data-policy-*

By Role

Role	Primary Folders	Context Folders
Executive	meta/, support/executive-briefing	business-drivers/strategic-context/
PBC Developer	companion-templates/, contracts/, gateways/	examples/pbc-journeys/, classifications/
Governance Setup	framework/governance/, gateways/	business-drivers/, assessments/
Agent Development	extensions/agent-extension/	examples/agent-scenarios/
Data Platform	reference-architectures/ref-002-dataplatform/	catalogs/G-CAF-044, support/data-policy-*

Chapter 8

NS Enhancement Recommendations

Gap analysis comparing G-CAF v1.12 against Antwerp Management School NS curriculum (Haerens, 2025).

Gap	Current State	Proposed Enhancement
No NS Concepts Guide	NS terms used without definition	Create practitioner-friendly NS primer
No Change Driver ID Guide	Change drivers in headers but no methodology	Step-by-step CD identification methodology
No Evolvability Metrics	Metrics focus on gateways and reuse	Add combinatorial effect detection metrics
Static/Dynamic Modularity implemented	Implemented but not explained	Document key NS insight explicitly
NS Anti-Patterns not explicit	Anti-patterns exist but not NS-linked	Link each anti-pattern to violated NS theorem
No Change Impact Assessment	Missing methodology	Bounded impact prediction methodology
AIT/DiT marked Adequate	Acknowledged in ns-compliance.md	Strengthen traceability mechanisms

Chapter 9

Release Notes (v1.12)

G-CAF v1.12 — Skills Matrix Standards

Component	Module ID	Purpose
Skills Matrix Standards	G-CAF-050	Enterprise-wide skills governance for PBC roles
PBC Template Section 25	G-CAF-COMPANION-001h	Skills specification per PBC
NS Compliance Analysis	Appendix	Full NS principle verification for v1.12

This release completes the Catalog Quad supporting frameworks: PBC Catalog (v1.0), Technology Catalog (v1.5), Data Asset Catalog (v1.6), Integration Asset Catalog (v1.7), Technical Debt (v1.8), Reference Architecture Patterns (v1.9), Environment Standards (v1.10), Accessibility & Localization (v1.11), and now Skills Matrix (v1.12).

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